Teaching notes

Taboo is a word guessing game. The objective is to have your team guess the keyword on top of a card. This must be accomplished without using the word itself or any of the additional 'taboo' (forbidden) words listed on the card.

1. Students work in teams (an even number with at least two people in each team).
2. Each team needs a set of cards. It is worth copying each set onto different coloured paper and/or laminating them to ensure that you have all the cards back at the end of the activity in order to reuse them.
3. The cards need to be cut out, and then shuffled and placed face down.
4. An individual from the first team takes the card from the top of the pile, and then describes the word at the top of the card without using the words below. The rest of their team must guess which word is described. Participants are not allowed to say 'sounds like' or 'rhymes with' and no gestures, sounds or drawings are permitted.
5. Should the individual use one of the taboo words, a member of the opposing team may challenge and the individual must move on to the next word.
6. Each individual is allowed two minutes to describe as many words as possible to the players in their team (a longer time may be required to allow more descriptions to take place) before play passes to the next team. There are no penalties for wrong guesses.
7. For each word which is correctly guessed, the playing team receives one point. Prizes/merits could be handed out to the winning team in each group.

This activity is designed to extend the students' vocabulary range by finding other ways to describe the keyword. It allows a review of scientific vocabulary in addition to reinforcing the students' memory of each scientific term.

In the lesson or homework prior to playing this game, the students could research meanings of new terms.

Extension activity

1. Each student puts a new vocabulary word at the top of a blank card.
2. Each student then has to write a further five words which are associated with the keyword they have written at the top of the card.

solid steel plastic wood particles vibrating touching packed hard shape	**liquid** particles water mercury shape container moving drink energy	**gas** air particles fast moving balloon pressure hydrogen carbon dioxide oxygen
particles solid liquid gas vibrate move atoms molecules	**bonds** force weak strong intermolecular atoms molecules	**flow** liquid gas solid particles energy movement
expansion properties heat energy vibrate particles density conduction bigger	**contraction** property heat energy smaller cooler temperature size particles	**pressure** gas heat high low expand contract balloon area force

diffusion liquid solid gas movement concentration high low particles	**particle** theory movement solids liquids gases energy vibration	**state** solid liquid gas change evaporation condensing freezing subliming water ice
property density sonorous malleable physical chemical	**dissolving** stir heat water soluble salt sugar insoluble	**heat** energy temperature rate reaction particles faster
sumblimation change state iodine solid gas liquid heat temperature	**evaporating** liquid gas particles energy faster escape kinetic heat	**freezing** solid liquid cold temperature ice water decrease energy

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